MERCY'S ANATOMY

Season 1, Episode 7

"The Crash-Out"

Episode 1x07. The counterpart of *Grey's Anatomy* 1x07. Narrator: Dr. Marc-Anthony Bullock

In-story dates: Thursday, August 18, 2005, 3:51 AM through Friday, August 19, 2005, 2:25 PM

Script: Cold Open + 5 Acts + Tag. 45 scenes. Standard: MA-009

Depends on MA-001 through MA-011 and episodes 1x01-1x06

EPISODE PDF PACKAGE (MA-009 §6): 1. Title page and cast (with ages on Thursday, August 18, 2005). 2. Script. 3. Media Companion. 4. Continuity Sheet.

Cast in Order of Appearance (Ages on Thursday, August 18, 2005)

Character	Role in this episode	Born	Age
Dr. Harmony Divine	Surgical Intern	Jun 19, 1979	26
Dr. Marc-Anthony Bullock	Surgical Intern (narrator)	Jan 5, 1979	26
Nurse Gloria Pettiford	Head ER Nurse	Apr 14, 1952	53
Dr. Elxa Bullock	Surgical Resident (about 14 weeks pregnant)	Aug 29, 1977	27
Dr. Arianna Cummings	Surgical Intern	Oct 25, 1979	25
Dr. Raven Ellison	Surgical Intern	Dec 3, 1979	25
Dr. Amond Baker	Surgical Intern	Feb 10, 1979	26
Lt. Tanisha 'Tee' Rollins	FDNY EMS Lieutenant	Aug 16, 1976	29
Malachi Grant (new)	Patient: non-accidental head trauma	Jan 3, 2001	4
Keyonna Grant (new)	Malachi's mother	Feb 14, 1984	21
Dante Pryce (new)	Keyonna's boyfriend	May 9, 1981	24
Dr. Leland Graves	Chief of Neurosurgery	Apr 18, 1953	52
Dr. Esther Smilley	Surgical Intern	Sep 20, 1979	25
Celia Montague, LCSW	Social Worker	May 6, 1966	39
Dr. Robert Bullock	Chief of Cardiothoracic Surgery	Feb 10, 1956	49
Jerome 'Romey' Battle (new)	Patient: recurrent tricuspid endocarditis	Jun 1, 1976	29
Delores Battle (new)	Romey's mother	Mar 22, 1947	58
Nevaeh Grant (new)	Malachi's sister	Mar 2, 1998	7
Ms. Thelma Rawls (new)	ACS Child Protective Specialist	Jan 17, 1953	52
Det. Andrea Vance (new)	NYPD Queens Child Abuse Squad	Jul 8, 1967	38
Howard Divine (on-screen debut)	Harmony's father; MTA bus operator	Aug 30, 1950	54
Raymond 'Big Ray' Toles	Chief of Security	Jan 1, 1960	45
Dr. Natasha Donohue	Chief of Surgery	Jun 2, 1958	47
Franklin Bassett, Esq.	General Counsel	Oct 28, 1958	46
Lamont 'Monty' Gaines	Owner, Monty's on Jackson	Oct 10, 1962	42
Russell Jeffries	Elxa's husband	Apr 3, 1975	30

Character	Role in this episode	Born	Age
Odessa Grant (new)	Malachi and Nevaeh's great-grandmother	Apr 4, 1937	68
Nurse Kendra Wallace	Surgical Floor Nurse	May 30, 1980	25

Also appearing: FDNY paramedic Andre Fontaine, a radiologist (V.O.), a Legal Aid attorney, a CNN anchor (on TV), ER and PICU nurses, and Monty's patrons. Mentioned: Jerome Battle Jr. (7), Grandma Josephine Bullock, Dr. Loretta Wise (EAP) and Dr. Isaiah Crump.

Black don't crack (C-018): every regular reads several years younger than their age on screen. The ages above are exact and binding.

COLD OPEN

1 INT. THE HOUSE ON 49TH AVENUE - UPSTAIRS HALLWAY - NIGHT
THURSDAY, AUGUST 18, 2005 - 3:51 AM

The hallway outside the bedrooms. On the wall, freshly framed, hangs the window countdown from Room 714: "DISCOVERY LANDING: TUESDAY, AUGUST 9." Under it, also framed, is a black silk bow tie.

Marc's bedroom door opens. MARC (26), already in scrubs, keys in hand, slips out quietly. Hollow-eyed. He stops in front of the frame. Looks at it for a long moment.

Down the hall, another door opens. HARMONY (26), in a bonnet and a church-camp T-shirt, squints at him.

HARMONY
(whispering)
It's three-fifty in the morning. Your shift doesn't start till six.

MARC
(whispering)
Picked up a peds consult shift. Crump's short.

HARMONY
You picked up a shift yesterday. And the day before. You've worked a hundred and four hours since Kingston.

MARC
(beat)
Ninety-eight. The Board doesn't count the stuff I do off the Board.

HARMONY
Marc.

MARC
(already on the stairs)
Go back to sleep, Harmony.

The front door closes. Harmony stands in the hallway, looking at the framed countdown and the bow tie.

MARC (V.O.)
Every surgeon learns where their limits are. Most of us learn it the hard way.

MARC (V.O.)
The trick is noticing when you've stopped looking for the brakes.

2 INT. PELL PAVILION - THE PIT - CENTRAL STATION - DAY
THURSDAY, AUGUST 18, 2005 - 6:20 AM

The Pit, early morning. On the TV mounted over the station, CNN is covering a sentencing.

ON THE TV: CNN. "BTK KILLER SENTENCED: Dennis Rader receives 10 consecutive life sentences in Wichita, Kansas." The crawl: "...victims' families confront Rader in court..."

NURSE GLORIA PETTIFORD (53) mutes it with the remote, disgusted.

GLORIA
I don't need that at six in the morning. (seeing Marc arrive) And I don't need you at six in the morning either. You've been here every morning for ten days.

MARC
(forced brightness)
I like it here.

GLORIA
(studying his face)
Baby, you look like a man who hasn't slept since the shuttle landed.

MARC
I sleep.

GLORIA
In what? An MRI tube?

Marc doesn't answer. He grabs a chart.

3 INT. OLD MAIN - RESIDENTS' LOUNGE - THE BOARD - DAY
THURSDAY, AUGUST 18, 2005 - 6:34 AM

Elxa (27), fourteen and a half weeks pregnant and just starting to show under her scrubs, at the Board. The

interns gather. Amond (26), Esther (25), Raven (25), Harmony, and Arianna (25), who is staring at an envelope in her hands like it might be a bomb.

ELXA
Bullock: peds and the Pit. Baker: Robert has an endocarditis consult in 6 West. Smilley: Graves. Ellison: floors. Divine: you're with me. Cummings, you're with Boykin, unless...

She sees the envelope in Arianna's hands. The return address: NATIONAL BOARD OF MEDICAL EXAMINERS.

ELXA
(beat)
Is that what I think it is?

ARIANNA
(flat)
Step 2. The retake. It came to my apartment yesterday. The program says I need a pass on file by August thirty-first or I lose my training license.

RAVEN
You haven't opened it?

ARIANNA
I've been holding it for twenty-two hours.

AMOND
That's not how envelopes work.

ARIANNA
(snapping)
I failed it once, Baker. I know exactly how envelopes work.

Silence. Elxa looks at her a long moment.

ELXA
(quieter)
Open it when you're ready, Cummings. But open it before the thirty-first.

4 INT. PELL PAVILION - THE PIT - TRAUMA 2 - DAY
THURSDAY, AUGUST 18, 2005 - 6:51 AM

The doors bang open. Lt. Tee Rollins and Andre Fontaine roll in a pediatric stretcher. On it, tiny, limp and unresponsive: MALACHI GRANT (4), in a SpongeBob pajama shirt, a bandage around his head, a splint on his right arm.

Behind the stretcher come a frightened young mother, KEYONNA GRANT (21), and her boyfriend, DANTE PRYCE (24), wiry and jittery, talking fast.

TEE
Four-year-old male. Mom's boyfriend says he fell down the stairs at their apartment in Astoria. GCS seven. Right arm deformity. Pupils are unequal. He vomited twice in the rig.

DANTE
(talking over her)
He fell down the stairs, man. I told them. He was running and he fell. I was in the kitchen. I heard him hit.

Marc is already at the stretcher with Elxa and a NURSE. He looks at the child. At the arm. He lifts the SpongeBob shirt to check the chest... and goes very still.

Malachi's back and ribs are covered in bruises. Old ones, yellow and green. New ones, purple. And on his upper arm, three small, perfectly round scars.

Cigarette burns.

Marc looks up. Directly at Dante. Dante looks away.

ELXA
(sharp, quiet)
Bullock. The patient.

Marc doesn't move. His jaw is working.

ELXA
(sharper)
BULLOCK.

MARC
(tearing his eyes away)
...CT head. Skeletal survey. Get neurosurgery down here. Now.

SMASH TO:

MAIN TITLE: MERCY'S ANATOMY

ACT ONE

5 INT. PELL PAVILION - CT SCANNER - CONTROL ROOM - DAY
THURSDAY, AUGUST 18, 2005 - 7:14 AM

The CT images come up on the screen: a large crescent of blood across the right side of Malachi's brain. Dr. Leland Graves (52) reads them with Esther beside him. Marc stands behind them, arms crossed so tightly his knuckles are pale.

GRAVES
Acute subdural hematoma, right side, with midline shift. And look here. An older collection under the new one. Different density. (beat) This is not the first time this child's head has been hit.

ESTHER
(quietly)
Two different ages of blood.

GRAVES
Weeks apart. (beat) We're taking him to the OR to evacuate it. Now.

The tech brings up the skeletal survey. A RADIOLOGIST (O.S.) dictates over the speaker.

RADIOLOGIST (V.O.)
Spiral fracture of the right humerus. Healing posterior rib fractures, left sixth through eighth, approximately two to four weeks old. A healing metaphyseal corner fracture of the left distal femur...

Marc turns and walks out of the room.

ESTHER
(watching him go)
Marc.

GRAVES
(not looking up)
Let him go, Smilley. Scrub.

6 INT. PELL PAVILION - THE PIT - FAMILY ROOM - DAY
THURSDAY, AUGUST 18, 2005 - 7:26 AM

Keyonna sits on the couch, shaking. Dante paces by the window, on his cell phone. Elxa stands near the door with CELIA MONTAGUE, LCSW (39), the hospital social worker, who's holding a clipboard. Marc stands in the doorway, very still.

CELIA
(gentle, professional)
Ms. Grant, I'm Celia Montague, the hospital social worker. When a child comes in with injuries like Malachi's, the law requires us to make a report to the State Central Register and the Administration for Children's Services. It's mandatory. It doesn't mean anyone's decided anything. It means somebody has to look.

KEYONNA
(crying)
He fell. Dante said he fell.

DANTE
(hanging up, aggressive)
He FELL. What's the problem? Kids fall. You're saying we did something?

CELIA
I'm not saying anything, Mr. Pryce. I'm explaining the process.

DANTE
(stepping toward her)
The process is you calling the cops on us because we're Black and we live in Astoria Houses.

Marc steps into the room.

MARC
(very quiet)
He has cigarette burns on his arm.

The room goes still.

MARC
(still quiet, but shaking)
Three of them. Round. About eight millimeters wide. Exactly the diameter of a cigarette. Stairs don't do that.

Dante looks at him. Something ugly flashes in his face.

DANTE
Who the hell are you?

ELXA
(stepping between them, low, iron)
Dr. Bullock. Hallway. Now.

7 INT. PELL PAVILION - THE PIT - CORRIDOR - CONTINUOUS
THURSDAY, AUGUST 18, 2005 - 7:29 AM

Elxa drags Marc by the sleeve around the corner, out of sight of the family room. She keeps her voice down to a lethal whisper.

ELXA
What are you doing?

MARC
(shaking)
Telling the truth.

ELXA
You're interrogating a suspect in front of a social worker. That's not your job. That's ACS's job. That's the NYPD's job. YOUR job is to keep that baby alive and document what you see.

MARC
(voice rising)
He burned him, Elxa. He put cigarettes out on a four-year-old's arm and then he stood in that room and said "kids fall"...

ELXA
(grabbing his arm)
Lower your voice.

MARC
(lower, but shaking harder)
I can't stand in a room with him.

ELXA
(beat, looking at her brother)
Then don't. (beat) Marc. When did you last sleep?

He doesn't answer.

ELXA
(softer)
You've been on the Board every day since Kingston. You're picking up shifts I didn't give you. Harmony called me at four-ten this morning.

MARC
(looking away)
Harmony needs to mind her business.

ELXA
Harmony lives in your house and watches you leave at three-fifty a.m. (beat) Go to the OR. Scrub in with Graves. Be useful to that baby. And stay away from that man.

8 INT. PELL PAVILION - 6 WEST - ROOM 611 - DAY
THURSDAY, AUGUST 18, 2005 - 7:48 AM

JEROME "ROMEY" BATTLE (29), rail thin, with track marks on both forearms and a PICC line in his arm, sits on the edge of the bed, sweating and shaking. Fever: 103.1. His mother, DELORES BATTLE (58), a retired transit worker,

sits in the chair with her purse in her lap like a shield. Robert reads the echo report. Amond stands beside him.

ROBERT
(to Amond, low)
Tricuspid valve endocarditis. A vegetation of about two centimeters. Severe regurgitation. Septic emboli in both lungs. (beat) This is his third episode in four years.

AMOND
(reading the chart)
He had a tricuspid repair in 2002. A tricuspid valve replacement in 2004. And now the replacement valve is infected.

ROMEY
(shaking)
I know what you're going to say, Doc. Everybody says it.

ROBERT
(turning to him)
What am I going to say, Mr. Battle?

ROMEY
That I keep shooting up and wrecking the valves you guys put in. That you're not doing it again.

DELORES
(sharp)
Jerome.

ROMEY
It's true, Mama. (to Robert) It's true. I been clean four months this time, Doc. Four months. Then my boy's mother wouldn't let me see him on his birthday, and I...

He stops. Covers his face.

ROBERT
(very evenly)
Mr. Battle, we'll start IV antibiotics and see how your body responds. We'll talk about surgery after the infectious disease team weighs in.

Robert walks out. Amond follows, catching up in the hallway.

9 INT. PELL PAVILION - 6 WEST - CORRIDOR - CONTINUOUS
THURSDAY, AUGUST 18, 2005 - 7:56 AM

AMOND
You're not going to operate.

ROBERT
(walking)
I haven't decided.

AMOND
You have. I can see it in your face. You've decided.

Robert stops. Turns.

ROBERT
A third valve surgery in an active IV drug user carries a mortality risk of maybe twenty percent, and the odds of reinfection, if he goes back to using, are high. Every time we put a valve in him, we're betting it won't be destroyed by the next needle. (beat) Some surgeons won't do it. Some programs have policies against it.

AMOND
Does Queens Grace?

ROBERT
(beat)
No.

AMOND
(surprising himself)
Then do it.

Robert raises an eyebrow. This is not what he expected from Amond.

AMOND
He's twenty-nine. He was clean for four months. He relapsed because he couldn't see his son on his birthday. (beat) If we don't operate, he dies. Maybe this week. If we do, maybe he dies, maybe he relapses... or maybe this is the time it sticks.

ROBERT
(studying him)
Two months ago you'd have said he made his choice.

AMOND
(beat)
Two months ago I'd never stayed up all night with a man refusing blood because of his faith. (beat) People's choices are complicated, Dr. Bullock. I'm learning that.

10 INT. PELL PAVILION - OR 1 - DAY
THURSDAY, AUGUST 18, 2005 - 8:22 AM

Malachi, tiny on the big table, his head shaved on one side, a craniotomy open. Graves works under the microscope, evacuating a dark clot. Esther assists. Marc holds suction, steady but tight.

GRAVES
Evacuating the acute clot. There's the chronic membrane underneath. (beat) Suction, Bullock.

Marc suctions. His hands are steady. His eyes aren't.

GRAVES
(beat, not looking up)
You held suction for me during an aneurysm rupture with your hands perfectly still. You're shaking now, Bullock.

MARC
I'm fine, sir.

GRAVES
(calm)
You're not. Your suction tip moved two millimeters toward the cortex. Two millimeters in a four-year-old is a stroke. (beat) Smilley. Take suction.

A beat. Esther looks at Marc. Marc looks at Graves.

GRAVES
(quiet, absolute)
That's not a punishment, Bullock. It's a fact. Step back from the table.

Marc hands the suction to Esther. He steps back. He stands against the wall of the OR, gowned and gloved, hands raised, staring at the floor.

11 INT. PELL PAVILION - PEDIATRIC FLOOR - PLAYROOM - DAY
THURSDAY, AUGUST 18, 2005 - 8:44 AM

A colorful playroom: beanbags, a fish tank, a shelf of donated books. Raven sits cross-legged on the floor across from NEVAEH GRANT (7), Malachi's big sister, in a school uniform from last spring that's too small for her. Nevaeh is coloring with ferocious concentration. She hasn't spoken.

RAVEN
That's a really good horse.

NEVAEH
(not looking up)
It's a unicorn.

RAVEN
Oh. I see it now. It's the horn.

Nevaeh keeps coloring. Hard. Pressing so hard the purple crayon snaps.

RAVEN
(gently)
You can have mine.

She hands Nevaeh a fresh purple crayon. Nevaeh takes it. Stops coloring. Looks at Raven for the first time.

NEVAEH
(barely audible)
Is Malachi going to die?

RAVEN
The doctors are fixing his head right now. The best brain doctor in New York.

NEVAEH
(beat)
Dante said if anybody asks, Malachi fell down the stairs.

Raven's face doesn't change. She keeps her voice exactly as soft as before.

RAVEN
Did Malachi fall down the stairs, Nevaeh?

Nevaeh looks at the unicorn. Then at the door. Then at Raven.

NEVAEH
(whispering)
We don't have stairs.

END OF ACT ONE

ACT TWO

12 INT. OLD MAIN - SOCIAL WORK OFFICE - DAY
THURSDAY, AUGUST 18, 2005 - 9:02 AM

Celia Montague's cramped office. Raven sits across from her, still holding a purple crayon she forgot to give back. Celia is already on the phone.

CELIA
(into the phone)
...yes, the State Central Register. I'm a mandated reporter at Queens Grace Hospital. Four-year-old male, Malachi Grant. Subdural hematoma, multiple fractures in different stages of healing, three circular burns consistent with cigarettes. The seven-year-old sibling made a spontaneous statement to a physician that contradicts the caretaker's account. (beat) Yes. The mother's boyfriend is in the building. (beat) Thank you.

She hangs up. Picks up the phone again and dials.

CELIA
(into the phone)
Queens Child Abuse Squad? This is Celia Montague at Queens Grace...

Raven sits there, turning the crayon over and over.

RAVEN
(small, when Celia hangs up)
"We don't have stairs." That's all she said. And then she went back to coloring.

CELIA
(gently)
Kids tell you the truth sideways, Dr. Ellison. You heard it. That's what matters.

RAVEN
(beat)
My mama used to tell my grandma I fell off my bike. (beat) I didn't have a bike.

Celia looks up. Raven stares at the crayon.

RAVEN
(quiet)
She wasn't a bad person. She was on crack. Grandma took me when I was six. (beat) I haven't thought about the bike in fifteen years.

CELIA
(taking off her glasses)
Raven. Are you okay to stay on this?

RAVEN
(looking up, fierce)
I'm the one she told. I'm staying.

13 INT. PELL PAVILION - STAIRWELL B - DAY
THURSDAY, AUGUST 18, 2005 - 9:30 AM

Arianna sits on the stairs with the envelope from the National Board of Medical Examiners on her knee. Harmony comes through the door from above, sees her and starts to back out.

ARIANNA
(not looking up)
Stay, Double-O.

Harmony sits two steps above her. They both look at the envelope.

HARMONY
You still haven't opened it?

ARIANNA
I failed it last year by four points. Four. I studied fourteen hours a day for two months this spring. If I failed again...

HARMONY
Then you take it again.

ARIANNA
(bitter)
There's no "again." The program said August thirty-first. If I fail, I'm out. Back to Gary. To my mother on a psych hold and my brother on the corner. (beat) That's what's in this envelope. Either the rest of my life or Gary.

Harmony comes down a step and sits beside her.

HARMONY
(quietly)
I froze in my first surgery. In front of the whole gallery. And you named me Double-O, and it was on the bathroom wall for a week.

ARIANNA
(wincing)
Yeah.

HARMONY
Then you changed it to "Licensed to Heal." (beat) Open the envelope, Gary. Whatever's in it, I'm sitting right here.

Arianna looks at her. Then she rips the envelope open. Pulls out the score report. Reads it.

Her face doesn't move. Harmony can't breathe.

HARMONY
(whispering)
Arianna?

ARIANNA
(barely audible)
One eighty-nine.

HARMONY
Is that...?

ARIANNA
(voice cracking)
Pass. It's a pass. (beat) It's a PASS.

She drops her head onto her knees. Her shoulders shake. Harmony puts her arms around her. Arianna lets her.

14 INT. PELL PAVILION - OR 1 - SCRUB ROOM - DAY
THURSDAY, AUGUST 18, 2005 - 9:51 AM

Marc stands at the long steel sink, scrubbing his hands. He's been scrubbing for a long time, well past clean, the way Harmony did on day one. Amond comes in and watches him.

AMOND
Your hands are clean. They've been clean for four minutes.

MARC
(not stopping)
Graves took me off the table.

AMOND
I heard. The whole floor heard. (beat) Two millimeters.

MARC
(scrubbing harder)
Two millimeters.

Amond reaches over and turns off the water. Marc stands there with his dripping hands raised.

AMOND
You've worked ninety-eight hours in ten days. You've slept maybe twenty. You haven't eaten anything that didn't come out of a vending machine since Kingston died.

MARC
(quiet, dangerous)
Don't, Amond.

AMOND
You told me you wanted to find out if you're any good. (beat) Here's your data: right now, you're not. Right now, you're a liability. Graves saw it. Elxa sees it. I see it.

Marc's jaw tightens. He grabs a towel and dries his hands roughly.

MARC
(low)
A four-year-old has cigarette burns on his arm, and the man who did it is sitting in the family room on his cell phone. You want me to go take a nap?

AMOND
(beat)
Yes. Because the next time you're at a table, you have to be steady. And you won't be.

Marc throws the towel in the bin and walks out.

15 INT. PELL PAVILION - PEDIATRIC FLOOR - CORRIDOR - DAY
THURSDAY, AUGUST 18, 2005 - 10:40 AM

Two new arrivals at the nurses' station. MS. THELMA RAWLS (52), ACS Child Protective Specialist, with a canvas tote bag full of files and the patience of a saint. And DETECTIVE ANDREA VANCE (38), NYPD Queens Child Abuse Squad, a gold shield clipped to her belt. Celia and Raven meet them.

MS. RAWLS
Where's the sibling?

RAVEN
The playroom. She's coloring.

DET. VANCE
She made a statement to you?

RAVEN
"Dante said if anybody asks, Malachi fell down the stairs. We don't have stairs."

Vance writes it down, word for word.

MS. RAWLS
(to Raven)
I'd like you in the room when I talk to her. She knows you. She trusts you. I won't ask leading questions. Just let her talk.

RAVEN
(nodding)
Okay.

DET. VANCE
And the boyfriend?

CELIA
Family room. He's been trying to leave for an hour. The mother keeps telling him to stay.

16 INT. PELL PAVILION - CAFETERIA - DAY
THURSDAY, AUGUST 18, 2005 - 11:24 AM

Harmony sits at a table with her father, HOWARD DIVINE (54), big, warm, in his MTA bus operator's uniform, on his lunch break. He's brought her a sandwich from home in a brown bag. He coughs: a deep, rattling cough that goes on a little long.

HARMONY
Daddy. That cough.

HOWARD
(waving it off)
Summer cold. Everybody on the Q4 has it.

HARMONY
You've had it since July. I heard it at the party.

HOWARD
(grinning)
You're a doctor now. Everything's a disease.

HARMONY
(beat)
Thirty-one years of bus exhaust. And you smoked until 1994.

HOWARD
Quit cold turkey. The day you got confirmed. (beat) Baby, I'm fine.

HARMONY
Then get a chest X-ray. For me. I'll walk you down to radiology right now. It takes ten minutes.

HOWARD
(shaking his head, laughing)
I've got a bus to drive at twelve-thirty.

HARMONY
Daddy.

HOWARD
(patting her hand)
After Labor Day. I promise. Your mama's already nagging me. I don't need two of you.

He coughs again. Harmony watches him. She doesn't push. She will remember that she didn't push.

17 INT. PELL PAVILION - 6 WEST - ROOM 611 - DAY
THURSDAY, AUGUST 18, 2005 - 12:15 PM

Romey Battle in bed, febrile and sweating, the IV antibiotics running. Delores still in her chair. Robert and Amond at the foot of the bed. Robert holds a single typed page.

ROBERT
Mr. Battle. Infectious Disease agrees: antibiotics alone won't clear this. You need a new valve. I'm willing to do the surgery tomorrow morning.

Romey looks up, stunned. Delores puts her hand over her mouth.

ROBERT
On conditions. (handing him the page) Dr. Baker drafted this.

ROMEY
(reading slowly)
"I agree to begin methadone maintenance before discharge. I agree to a twenty-eight-day inpatient rehabilitation program at Phoenix House immediately following recovery. I agree to weekly follow-up with Dr. Baker's clinic..."

AMOND
(stiffly)
Dr. Bullock's clinic.

ROMEY
(still reading)
"...and I agree that the person I'm staying clean for is..." (he stops) There's a blank.

AMOND
(beat)
You fill that in yourself.

Romey looks at the blank for a long time. Then he picks up a pen from the tray table and writes, slowly, in shaky handwriting: "MY SON, JEROME JR. (7)."

DELORES
(whispering, crying)
Lord.

ROMEY
(signing it, handing it back, eyes wet)
Doc. Is this legal? A contract like this?

ROBERT
(beat)
No. It's not legally binding. Nothing about it is enforceable. (beat) It's a promise. To your son. And to Dr. Baker. Dr. Baker convinced me you were worth one more valve.

Romey looks at Amond, shocked.

ROMEY
You?

AMOND
(uncomfortable, looking at the floor)
You were clean for four months. That's data. (beat) Don't make me wrong.

18 INT. PELL PAVILION - PEDIATRIC FLOOR - PLAYROOM - DAY
THURSDAY, AUGUST 18, 2005 - 1:05 PM

Nevaeh coloring. Raven sits beside her. Ms. Rawls sits on a tiny chair, completely relaxed, a coloring book of her own in her lap. Detective Vance stands quietly by the door, out of Nevaeh's eyeline.

MS. RAWLS
(coloring, casual)
That's a pretty unicorn. Does Malachi like unicorns?

NEVAEH
He likes trucks.

MS. RAWLS
Trucks. That's cool. (beat) Who takes care of you and Malachi when Mommy's at work?

NEVAEH
(beat)
Dante.

MS. RAWLS
What's that like?

Nevaeh's crayon stops. She doesn't answer. Raven gently puts her hand next to Nevaeh's on the table. Not touching. Just there.

NEVAEH
(very quiet)
He gets mad when Malachi cries. (beat) He smokes on the fire escape. He says Malachi is a crybaby. (beat) He makes Malachi hold still.

Ms. Rawls nods slowly, still coloring. Vance writes, silent. Raven's eyes fill. She doesn't let her face change.

NEVAEH
(looking up at Raven)
Am I in trouble?

RAVEN
(steady, gentle)
No, baby. You're the bravest girl I've ever met.

19 INT. PELL PAVILION - PEDIATRIC FLOOR - CORRIDOR - DAY
THURSDAY, AUGUST 18, 2005 - 1:31 PM

Marc comes around the corner with a chart, heading for the PICU. Down the hall, the family room door bangs open. Dante storms out, Keyonna behind him, grabbing his arm.

KEYONNA
Dante, they said to wait!

DANTE
(shaking her off)
I ain't waiting for no cops. That little girl's been in there with those people for an hour. What's she telling them?

He heads straight for the playroom. The playroom door is half open. Through it: Nevaeh at the table with her crayons. She looks up, sees Dante coming, and freezes in terror.

DANTE
(shouting, closing in)
NEVAEH! What did you TELL them?

Marc drops the chart. In four long strides he's between Dante and the playroom door.

MARC
Stop.

DANTE
Get out of my way.

MARC
(very calm)
Turn around.

DANTE
(squaring up)
Or what, Doctor?

Dante shoves him. Marc doesn't move. Six-foot-five and immovable.

DANTE
(louder)
MOVE!

Dante swings, a wild punch at Marc's head. Marc catches the arm mid-swing, turns, and pins Dante face-first against the corridor wall, one forearm across his shoulders. Hard. Controlled. Dante can't move.

And then something in Marc breaks loose. Ten days without sleep. Kingston. The burns. Every single thing he's been holding.

MARC
(roaring, inches from Dante's ear)
YOU BURNED HIM! YOU PUT CIGARETTES OUT ON A FOUR-YEAR-OLD! HE'S FOUR! HE WEIGHS THIRTY-SIX POUNDS! HE LIKES TRUCKS! AND YOU MADE HIM HOLD STILL!

The whole pediatric floor goes silent. Nurses frozen. A parent in a doorway clutching a toddler. Keyonna screaming. Inside the playroom, Raven has pulled Nevaeh behind her and is shielding the child with her body.

MARC
(voice cracking, still holding him)
YOU DON'T GET TO TOUCH HER! YOU DON'T GET TO LOOK AT HER! YOU DON'T GET TO...

Big hands on Marc's shoulders. Big Ray Toles, out of breath, pulling him back.

BIG RAY
(firm, low)
Doc. Doc. I got him. Let go. I got him. LET GO.

Detective Vance is there too, cuffs out, taking Dante by the arm. Marc lets go. He staggers back against the opposite wall, chest heaving, shaking all over.

Down the corridor, at the nurses' station, Elxa has seen all of it. Gloria has seen all of it. And behind them, just stepping off the elevator, Natasha Donohue has seen all of it.

END OF ACT TWO

ACT THREE

20 INT. PELL PAVILION - PEDIATRIC FLOOR - CORRIDOR - CONTINUOUS
THURSDAY, AUGUST 18, 2005 - 1:33 PM

Detective Vance cuffs Dante against the wall.

DET. VANCE
Dante Pryce, you're under arrest for assault. Attempted assault on a physician in a hospital. That's a felony in New York, buddy. Additional charges are pending. You have the right to remain silent...

DANTE
(twisting to glare at Marc)
HE put his hands on ME! You all saw it!

DET. VANCE
(dry)
What I saw was you swing at a doctor's head. And him stop you. (to a UNIFORMED OFFICER who's arrived) Take him down.

Dante is hauled away toward the elevators, still shouting. Keyonna slides down the wall, sobbing. Raven comes out of the playroom holding Nevaeh's hand. Nevaeh is staring at Marc.

Marc slowly looks up. He sees Nevaeh. Sees the fear on her face, and realizes, with horror, that some of it might be fear of him.

MARC
(hoarse, crouching, gentle)
I'm sorry. I'm sorry I yelled, Nevaeh. I'm sorry I was loud.

Nevaeh looks at him for a long moment.

NEVAEH
(small)
You yelled at Dante.

MARC
(beat)
Yeah.

NEVAEH
(beat)
Nobody ever yells at Dante.

Natasha walks up the corridor. The crowd parts. She stops in front of Marc, who straightens. She's the Chief. Nothing else.

NATASHA
(quiet, cold)
Dr. Bullock. My office. Fifteen minutes. (to Elxa) You too, Dr. Bullock.

21 INT. OLD MAIN - CHIEF OF SURGERY'S OFFICE - DAY
THURSDAY, AUGUST 18, 2005 - 1:52 PM

Natasha behind her desk. Franklin Bassett with his legal pad. Big Ray standing by the door. Elxa. And Marc, standing at attention, hands still trembling.

BASSETT
Mr. Pryce has already told the arresting officers he intends to sue the hospital and Dr. Bullock personally for assault.

BIG RAY
(firm)
Mr. Pryce swung at the doctor's head, Chief. I saw it from the station. I've got the security video. The doc caught his arm and pinned him. He didn't throw a single punch. He didn't hurt him.

BASSETT
The video will help. A lot. But the shouting...

NATASHA
(cutting him off)
I heard the shouting. The whole floor heard the shouting. (to Marc) Dr. Bullock. Did Mr. Pryce strike first?

MARC
Yes, Chief.

NATASHA
Was a child in danger?

MARC
Yes, Chief. Nevaeh. He was going for her.

NATASHA
(beat)
And after you'd restrained him, and the danger was over, did you continue to scream in his face in front of a seven-year-old, a dozen parents, and the nursing staff of my pediatric floor?

Marc's face goes still.

MARC
(quiet)
Yes, Chief.

A long silence.

NATASHA
(even)
Here is what happens. Mr. Bassett will defend you, and this hospital will defend you, because you were protecting a child from a man who swung first. That's not in question. (beat) But you are also an intern who's worked ninety-eight hours in ten days in violation of the duty-hour rules, who was removed from an OR this morning for unsteady hands, and who lost control on a pediatric ward. (beat) You're on paid administrative leave for forty-eight hours, effective immediately. You'll be evaluated by the Employee Assistance Program before you return to the floor. Monday morning, eight a.m. Dr. Loretta Wise.

ELXA
(stepping forward)
Chief, with respect, he...

NATASHA
(not looking at her)
Dr. Bullock, your intern logged ninety-eight hours on your service and you signed off on them.

ELXA
(stung)
I didn't sign off on the extra shifts. He picked them up with Crump.

NATASHA
Then talk to Crump. (beat) That's all. Mr. Bassett, Mr. Toles, thank you.

Bassett and Big Ray leave. Elxa hesitates, looks at her mother, then at her brother. She leaves too. The door closes.

Natasha and Marc, alone. She doesn't move from behind the desk.

MARC
(very quiet)
Mom.

NATASHA
(beat)
Not yet. (beat) Not here. Not today. If I come around this desk right now, everything I just said becomes a lie. Do you understand?

MARC
(barely)
Yes.

NATASHA
(her voice breaking just slightly)
Go home, baby. Sleep. Please. I'm begging you as your Chief.

22 INT. PELL PAVILION - PEDIATRIC ICU - BED 6 - DAY
THURSDAY, AUGUST 18, 2005 - 2:40 PM

Malachi, post-op, a bandage wrapped around his small head, intubated and sedated. His arm is in a cast. A stuffed truck someone from the nursing staff found sits on his pillow. Esther checks his pupils. Keyonna sits in the

corner, hollowed out. Ms. Rawls stands nearby with her clipboard.

ESTHER
(to Keyonna, gently)
His pupils are reactive. Equal. The pressure in his head is coming down. Dr. Graves is cautiously optimistic.

Keyonna nods without seeing her.

KEYONNA
(barely audible)
I knew.

Esther stops. Ms. Rawls looks up.

KEYONNA
(staring at her son)
Not the burns. I swear to God, not the burns. But the bruises. I knew he was rough. I told myself Malachi was clumsy. I told myself Dante was trying. I told myself I couldn't afford the rent without him. (beat) I'm twenty-one. I had Nevaeh when I was fourteen. My mother's boyfriend used to... (she stops) I thought this was just what men were.

Silence. Ms. Rawls sits down next to her.

MS. RAWLS
(gently)
Ms. Grant. I have to tell you that the children won't be released to your care right now. We're going to look at placing them with a relative. Do you have family?

KEYONNA
(crying)
My grandmother. In Jamaica. Queens. She's sixty-eight. She raised me. She'd take them.

MS. RAWLS
Then that's where we start. (beat) And you're going to get help, too. Services. A domestic violence advocate. Counseling. This isn't the end of you being their mother, Keyonna. It's the beginning of you being a safe one.

23 INT. OLD MAIN - INTERNS' LOCKER ROOM - DAY
THURSDAY, AUGUST 18, 2005 - 3:15 PM

Marc at his locker, changing slowly into street clothes. Ordered home. The room is empty. Then the door opens and Arianna comes in. She hesitates, sees him, and sits on the bench across from him.

ARIANNA
I passed my boards.

MARC
(looking up, a real smile breaking through)
Arianna. That's amazing. That's...

ARIANNA
One eighty-nine. Double-O sat with me when I opened it. (beat) I wanted to tell you because you're having the worst day of your life, and I figured you could use one piece of good news.

MARC
(quiet)
Thank you.

Arianna looks at him for a long moment. Then she lowers her voice.

ARIANNA
You know what I said on day one? About you being a terrible liar?

MARC
(wary)
You said a lot of things on day one.

ARIANNA
(beat)
I saw him, Bullock. Your grandfather. Last Tuesday at dawn, outside Kingston's room. I saw him hug you.

Marc freezes, his shirt half-buttoned.

ARIANNA
I haven't told anybody. Not Kendra. Not anybody. And I'm not going to. (beat) I just figured, after today, you should know there's one more person who has your back. Even the one from Gary.

MARC
(stunned)
Why?

ARIANNA
(shrugging, standing up)
You yelled at Dante. (beat) Nobody ever yelled at my dad. (at the door) Go home, Common Name.

24 EXT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - JACKSON AVENUE ENTRANCE - DAY
THURSDAY, AUGUST 18, 2005 - 3:40 PM

Marc walks out the front door into the August heat in jeans and a T-shirt, his bag over his shoulder. Esther, on her way back in from a coffee run, sees him.

ESTHER
(stopping)
Marc. I heard.

MARC
(not stopping)
Everyone heard.

ESTHER
(walking beside him)
Where are you going?

MARC
Home. Forty-eight hours. Paid leave. "Evaluate my fitness." (beat, laughing hollowly) I'm the Chief's... I'm the Chief's problem intern now.

ESTHER
(catching that tiny stumble)
Marc.

MARC
(stopping, turning)
I'm fine, Esther.

ESTHER
You're not. You're the least fine person I've ever met. (beat) You protected that little girl. You were right. And you're walking out of this hospital like you're the one who did something wrong.

MARC
(quiet)
I scared her. Nevaeh. When I was yelling, I saw her face. She looked at me like I was Dante.

Esther doesn't have an answer for that.

MARC
(beat)
I have to go.

He walks off down Jackson Avenue. Esther watches him go. Then she pulls out her RAZR and dials.

ESTHER
(into the phone)
Harmony? Where are you right now?

25 INT. MONTY'S ON JACKSON - BAR - NIGHT
THURSDAY, AUGUST 18, 2005 - 9:42 PM

Monty's on a Thursday night: dim, half full, the Mets game muted on the TV over the bar. Monty (42) polishes glasses behind the bar. And at the end of the bar, alone, with four empty shot glasses lined up in front of him and a fifth in his hand: Marc.

MONTY
(gently)
That's five, Doc.

MARC
(slurring slightly)
I can count, Monty. I'm a doctor. I went to Hopkins.

MONTY
(taking the bottle away)
Then you can count to "that's enough." (beat) You haven't been in here since the night before your first day. Since you left with the elegant one.

MARC
(staring into the glass)
I'm suspended.

MONTY
I heard. Whole block heard. The doc who pinned the boyfriend. (beat) Proud of you, by the way. For what it's worth.

MARC
(bitter)
Everybody's proud of me. I put my hands on a man in front of a seven-year-old, and I'm on leave, and Kingston's dead, and I couldn't stop Dante from burning a baby, and everybody's PROUD of me.

He knocks back the shot. Slams the glass down. Monty watches him with the eyes of a man who's seen a thousand people at the end of his bar.

The front door opens. Hot night air. Esther walks in, still in scrubs, her hair falling out of its bun. She sees Marc. She sees the five glasses.

MONTY
(quietly, to himself)
Thank God.

END OF ACT THREE

ACT FOUR

26 INT. MONTY'S ON JACKSON - BAR - CONTINUOUS
THURSDAY, AUGUST 18, 2005 - 9:43 PM

Esther crosses the bar and slides onto the stool beside Marc. She doesn't say anything. She just moves the five shot glasses, one by one, out of his reach.

MARC
(not looking at her)
Harmony sent you.

ESTHER
I sent me. Harmony told me you weren't home. Big Ray told me you turned left on Jackson instead of right. Left on Jackson is Monty's. (beat) I'm a very good detective.

MARC
You're a very good surgeon.

ESTHER
I'm an intern. I've done four appendectomies. Let's not get ahead of ourselves.

That almost gets a smile out of him. Almost.

MONTY
(setting down a glass of water in front of Marc)
On the house. Drink it.

MARC
(to the water)
You know what Graves said to me this morning? Two millimeters. My hand was shaking two millimeters. That's the width of... (he holds up his fingers, a tiny gap) ...that. That's the distance between me and a kid who can't move the left side of his body for the rest of his life.

ESTHER
He took you off the table. That's what attendings do. That's what they're supposed to do.

MARC
(louder)
I KNOW what they're supposed to do. (beat, quieter) I know. (beat) You want to know the stupid part? I picked up those shifts on purpose. Every single one. Because if I'm in the hospital, I'm not in that house looking at a frame on the wall that says "Tuesday, August 9."

ESTHER
(softly)
Kingston.

MARC
He was ten. He wanted to be an astronaut. I promised him he'd see the landing. And he did. And then he died ninety minutes later, and I went back to work, because what else do you do. (beat) And then today some guy is burning a four-year-old with cigarettes, and the one time I actually get to stop something bad from happening, I do it so loud that the little girl I'm protecting looks at me like I'm the monster.

A couple at a table nearby glances over. Monty gives them a look. They go back to their wings.

ESTHER
You stopped him.

MARC
I didn't stop. That's the problem. (beat) Big Ray had to pull me off. I didn't stop, Esther. I didn't even know I was yelling. I was just... gone. Like somebody pulled the brakes out of the car.

ESTHER
(beat)
Has that happened before?

Marc looks at the water.

MARC
(quiet)
When I was fifteen. A kid at Collegiate called my sister something. (beat) And once in Baltimore. A man outside the Hopkins ER, hitting his girlfriend in the parking lot. (beat) My father calls it "the Bullock temper." My mother calls it "the thing we don't put in writing."

ESTHER
What do you call it?

MARC
(laughing, hollow)
Me. I call it me. (beat) Everybody's so proud of me. The good son, the Hopkins kid, the guy who says "yes ma'am" to the nurses. Nobody ever met the guy Big Ray met today.

ESTHER
(steady)
I did. Just now. (beat) He's sitting at a bar crying about a four-year-old he saved. He's not as scary as he thinks.

Marc turns and looks at her for the first time. His eyes are wet.

ESTHER
Come on. I'm taking you home.

MARC
(fumbling for his wallet)
I have to pay Monty.

MONTY
(waving him off)
Doc. You pinned a man who burns babies. Your money's no good in here tonight. (beat, to Esther) Get him home. And make him eat something with bread in it.

27 EXT. THE HOUSE ON 49TH AVENUE - STOOP - NIGHT
THURSDAY, AUGUST 18, 2005 - 10:21 PM

The house is dark except for the porch light. Esther digs in Marc's pocket for his keys. He sits down heavily on the stoop instead of going inside. After a moment, she sits beside him.

MARC
(looking at the house)
You know my parents gave me this house.

ESTHER
You told me. Graduation present.

MARC
(beat)
It's not really from them. (beat) Esther, I have to tell you something. I've been trying to tell you since July. About my family. You already guessed my mother is the Chief. Mrs. Truitt. You were right. But my mother's father is...

ESTHER
(cutting him off, gently)
Stop.

MARC
I want to tell you.

ESTHER
I know you do. (beat) And I want to hear it. But not like this. Not with five shots of Hennessy in you. (beat) Don't tell me drunk, Marc. Tell me sober. When you choose to. Not because today broke you open and it fell out.

Marc stares at her.

MARC
(quiet)
That's the nicest thing anybody's ever said to me.

ESTHER
(standing, holding out her hand)
Then you're going to love the next part. It's called "drink the Gatorade and go to sleep."

He takes her hand. She pulls him up.

ESTHER
(looking at the house as she unlocks the door)
Also, whatever it is, I've figured out it involves a lot of money. Your couch costs more than my boat.

MARC
(stopping in the doorway)
How do you know how much my couch costs?

ESTHER
I looked it up. It's a fantastic couch, Marc.

28 INT. THE HOUSE ON 49TH AVENUE - MARC'S BEDROOM - NIGHT
THURSDAY, AUGUST 18, 2005 - 10:38 PM

Esther pulls off Marc's sneakers. He lies on top of the covers in his T-shirt and jeans. She puts the Gatorade and two Advil on the nightstand, then a trash can beside the bed, just in case.

MARC
(eyes closed)
You're good at this.

ESTHER
My uncle drank. After my father died, he stayed with us for a while to "help." (beat) Every night. I was very good at sneakers and trash cans by the time I was nine.

Marc opens his eyes.

MARC
You never told me that.

ESTHER
(sitting on the edge of the bed)
There's a lot I haven't told you. (beat) So we're even.

MARC
(drowsy)
Are you staying?

ESTHER
(beat)
I'm sleeping on the fantastic couch. Somebody has to make sure you don't choke on your own vomit. Medically speaking.

MARC
(almost asleep)
Very romantic.

ESTHER
(standing, turning off the lamp)
Good night, Marc.

She stands in the doorway, watching him breathe. Then she reaches into her scrub pocket and touches the chain around her neck. The ring she wears under her shirt. She holds it for a moment, eyes closed.

Then she lets go and closes the door.

29 INT. ELXA AND RUSSELL'S HOUSE - ST. ALBANS - KITCHEN - NIGHT
THURSDAY, AUGUST 18, 2005 - 10:52 PM

Elxa (27) sits at the kitchen table in her robe, eating saltines out of the sleeve, a cup of ginger tea going cold. RUSSELL JEFFRIES (30) comes in from the bedroom.

RUSSELL
You're supposed to be asleep. Doctor's orders. Literally, your doctor.

ELXA
My brother put a man on the floor today.

RUSSELL
(sitting down)
Marc?

ELXA
In front of Gloria. In front of half the ER. In front of my MOTHER. (beat) I watched it happen, Russell. I was twenty feet away and I couldn't get to him. And all I could think was, "There it is." I haven't seen it since he was fifteen.

RUSSELL
The thing at Collegiate.

ELXA
(nodding)
Daddy went to the school. Mama went to the board. It went away. Everything about us goes away. (beat) Except it doesn't. It just waits.

RUSSELL
Is he okay?

ELXA
He's suspended. He's not okay. (beat) And I'm three months pregnant, and I'm sitting here trying to figure out if I should go over there right now in my robe, or let him be a grown man.

RUSSELL
(gently)
Let him be a grown man till morning. (beat) Then bring him crackers.

ELXA
(looking down at the sleeve)
These are MY crackers.

RUSSELL
I'll buy you more crackers.

30 INT. NATASHA AND ROBERT'S BROWNSTONE - UPPER WEST SIDE - STUDY - NIGHT
THURSDAY, AUGUST 18, 2005 - 11:14 PM

Riverside Drive. A wood-paneled study lined with medical journals and framed photos of the children at every age. NATASHA (47) sits at the desk in reading glasses, the incident report in front of her. ROBERT (49) stands in the doorway with his tie loosened.

ROBERT
You suspended our son.

NATASHA
(not looking up)
I placed an intern on forty-eight hours of paid administrative leave pending an Employee Assistance evaluation. Per policy.

ROBERT
(coming in)
Per policy. Tasha, he stopped a man from grabbing a seven-year-old. The man swung first. Big Ray's statement says so. Gloria's says so. Vance's says so.

NATASHA
And all three statements also say that Big Ray had to physically remove him. That he didn't hear his name being called four times. (beat) Robert. He didn't hear his NAME.

Robert stops.

NATASHA
(taking off her glasses)
If he were anybody else's son, I would have done exactly the same thing. And you would have agreed with me. You would have said "that resident needs an evaluation" before I finished the sentence.

ROBERT
He's not anybody else's son.

NATASHA
(sharp)
That is EXACTLY why it had to be by the book. Do you know what happens if somebody finds out the Chief let her own child walk away from an assault without consequences? Bassett's phone rang four times tonight. The Daily News has the arrest. They don't have his name. Yet.

ROBERT
(quiet)
And if they find out who his grandfather is?

NATASHA
(beat)
Then it's not a hospital story anymore. It's a front page.

Silence. Robert sits down across from her.

ROBERT
He's been running himself into the ground since that boy died. I saw it. You saw it. And neither of us said anything.

NATASHA
(looking at a photo on the desk: Marc at about eight, missing a front tooth)
I said "go home and sleep." Three times. (beat) He said "yes ma'am." He's always said "yes ma'am." That's the problem with raising a polite child, Robert. You never know when they're lying to you.

ROBERT
(beat)
Did you call him?

NATASHA
I'm his Chief tonight. Not his mother.

ROBERT
(standing up)
Then I'll be his father. Somebody in this house should be.

He leaves. Natasha sits alone with the incident report. Then she picks up the phone, dials half of a number and puts it back down.

31 INT. THE HOUSE ON 49TH AVENUE - LIVING ROOM - NIGHT
FRIDAY, AUGUST 19, 2005 - 1:07 AM

The front door opens quietly. Harmony and Raven come in from a late shift, still in scrubs, carrying takeout from the Thai place on Vernon. Harmony stops dead.

Esther is asleep on the couch under a throw blanket, still in her scrubs, one arm hanging off the side.

RAVEN
(whispering)
Is that...

HARMONY
(whispering)
Esther.

RAVEN
(whispering, grinning)
On the fantastic couch.

HARMONY
(whispering, not grinning)
Shh.

Harmony looks toward the stairs. Marc's door, closed. Back at Esther. Something moves across her face, gone as fast as it came.

RAVEN
(whispering)
You okay?

HARMONY
(whispering)
She found him. I called her and she found him. (beat) That's good. That's what I wanted.

Raven looks at her for a long beat. Raven isn't stupid.

RAVEN
(whispering)
Okay.

Harmony takes the blanket from the back of the armchair and lays it over Esther's feet, which are sticking out from under the throw. Then she goes upstairs without eating.

Raven stands alone in the living room holding two containers of pad see ew.

32 INT. THE HOUSE ON 49TH AVENUE - HARMONY'S BEDROOM - NIGHT
FRIDAY, AUGUST 19, 2005 - 1:15 AM

Harmony sits on her bed in the dark. She takes a folded piece of notebook paper out of her scrub pocket. The letter. "Dear Marc." She unfolds it. Reads the first line in the light from the streetlamp.

She refolds it, carefully, along the same creases. Puts it in the drawer of her nightstand, under her Bible. Then she takes it back out and puts it in her pocket again.

Her flip phone buzzes. A text. She looks at it.

SMS, from ARIANNA: "u still up. cant sleep. 189 keeps playing in my head like a song"

Harmony smiles in spite of herself. Types back.

SMS, from HARMONY: "go to sleep Gary. u passed. u'll still pass in the morning"

END OF ACT FOUR

ACT FIVE

33 INT. THE HOUSE ON 49TH AVENUE - KITCHEN - MORNING
FRIDAY, AUGUST 19, 2005 - 7:48 AM

Bright August light through the windows. Marc shuffles in, barefoot, wearing yesterday's T-shirt, looking like a man who's been hit by a crosstown bus. There's coffee in the pot. A mug sits beside it with a Post-it note stuck to it.

> POST-IT, in Esther's handwriting: "Drink this. Then water. Then eat. I walked to work. Call me when you're human. -E"

Marc pours the coffee. Sips it. Closes his eyes.

His phone, on the counter, has four missed calls. DAD (2). ELXA. AMOND. And one text.

> SMS, from ESTHER (6:41 AM): "u snore. its not cute. ok its a little cute"

Marc laughs. It hurts his head. He calls her.

ESTHER (V.O.)
(over the phone, hospital noise in the background)
He's alive.

MARC
Barely. (beat) Esther. Last night. What I almost said.

ESTHER (V.O.)
You didn't say it.

MARC
I'm sober now. I could say it now.

A pause on the line. Long enough that he checks to see if the call dropped.

ESTHER (V.O.)
(softly)
Are you saying it because you're ready? Or because you're scared I'll leave if you don't?

Marc doesn't answer.

ESTHER (V.O.)
That's what I thought. (beat) Then later can still be later. When you're ready. Not because you're broken. (beat) I'm not going anywhere, Marc.

Marc looks at the Post-it.

MARC
(quiet)
Okay.

ESTHER (V.O.)
Okay. (beat) Drink your water.

Click. Marc stands in the kitchen holding the phone. On the fridge, under a Mets magnet, is the chore chart Harmony made in July. His name is on "trash" this week. He hasn't done it in ten days.

He puts the phone down and takes out the trash.

34 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - OR 2 - DAY
FRIDAY, AUGUST 19, 2005 - 8:30 AM

Romey Battle on the table, his chest open. Robert at the head of the table. Amond across from him, gowned, gloved, intense. The bypass machine hums. Romey's heart lies still under the lights.

ROBERT
(working)
Tell me what I'm looking at, Dr. Baker.

AMOND
The tricuspid annulus. The bioprosthetic valve from 2003 has vegetations on all three leaflets. Abscess at the septal leaflet. (beat) The infection has eaten into the annulus.

ROBERT
So?

AMOND
So we debride all of the infected tissue, even if it costs us annulus. Reconstruct with a pericardial patch if we have to. New valve. Then we pray for six weeks of IV antibiotics and twenty-eight days at Phoenix House.

ROBERT
(beat)
You left out a step.

AMOND
(thinking)
...Check for a VSD after debriding the septal leaflet.

ROBERT
(approving)
There it is. (to the scrub nurse) Fifteen blade.

They work. Long, careful minutes.

ROBERT
(not looking up)
You put your name on that contract yesterday, Dr. Baker. "Weekly follow-up with Dr. Baker." That wasn't my idea.

AMOND
(not looking up)
You said he needed somebody he'd be letting down.

ROBERT
I said that. I didn't say it had to be you. (beat) Interns don't have clinics. You'll be doing that on your own time.

AMOND
Wednesdays. Five o'clock. I already asked Deb for an empty exam room.

Robert glances up at him over his mask. Something like pride.

ROBERT
Why this one?

AMOND
(beat)
My father didn't get one more anything. Stocker Street, 1988. I was nine. (beat) Romey's still alive. He gets one more.

Robert doesn't say anything. He holds out his hand.

ROBERT
Sizer. (beat) Twenty-nine. Dr. Baker, you're going to seat this valve.

AMOND
(stunned)
Sir?

ROBERT
Three sutures. I'll do the rest. (beat) Steady hands. Show me.

Amond takes the needle driver. His hands are perfectly steady.

35 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - PICU - ROOM 4 - DAY
FRIDAY, AUGUST 19, 2005 - 9:15 AM

Malachi Grant, small in the big bed, the bandage around his head. His eyes are open. He's extubated and breathing on his own. Celia sits at his bedside. Raven stands in the doorway.

CELIA
(to Raven)
He squeezed with both hands this morning. Graves did the evacuation clean. No deficits so far. (beat) Your man Bullock wasn't the only one holding his breath.

RAVEN
(coming in)
He's not my man.

CELIA
Figure of speech, Ellison.

Raven crouches by the bed so she's eye level with Malachi.

RAVEN
Hey, Malachi. I'm Raven. I know your sister.

Malachi just stares at her. Four years old and already careful.

RAVEN
She drew you a picture. You want to see it?

She holds up the unicorn. Purple and green. The horn colored in gold. Malachi's eyes go to it.

MALACHI
(barely a whisper)
Nevvy.

RAVEN
(eyes filling)
Yeah. Nevvy made it.

She tapes it to the bed rail where he can see it.

36 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - FAMILY LOUNGE - PEDIATRIC FLOOR - DAY
FRIDAY, AUGUST 19, 2005 - 9:31 AM

Ms. Rawls sits with Nevaeh and an elderly woman: GREAT-GRANDMOTHER ODESSA GRANT (68), church hat, pocketbook in her lap, her back as straight as a broom handle. Nevaeh has a new drawing in progress.

MS. RAWLS
(to Odessa)
The temporary order was signed at Family Court in Jamaica at eight this morning. Both children are placed with you in kinship foster care while the case goes forward. Keyonna can have supervised visits once she's in a program.

ODESSA
(firm)
She'll be in a program. I'll drive her myself.

MS. RAWLS
And Mr. Pryce has an order of protection against him. He's not allowed within a thousand feet of your house, the children or their school.

ODESSA
(beat)
Ms. Rawls, I buried a husband and a son. I got a .38 my husband left me and a pastor who visits every Tuesday. That man won't come near my house.

MS. RAWLS
(carefully)
I'm going to pretend I didn't hear the first part of that.

ODESSA
You do that, baby.

Raven appears in the doorway. Nevaeh looks up and her whole face changes.

NEVAEH
Did he see it?

RAVEN
(coming in, kneeling)
He saw it. He said your name. He said "Nevvy."

Nevaeh drops her crayon. She doesn't cry. She just sits very still and takes a long breath, the way grownups do when something they've been carrying gets set down.

NEVAEH
(beat)
I made you one too.

She tears the new drawing out of the pad and hands it to Raven. A girl on a bicycle. Purple bicycle. A woman in blue scrubs running behind her, holding on to the seat.

RAVEN
(looking at it, can't speak)
...

NEVAEH
You said you didn't have a bike.
So I drew you one.

Raven holds the drawing with both hands. She nods. She can't do anything else.

ODESSA
(watching, to Ms. Rawls, quietly)
That one's had a hard life too.

MS. RAWLS
(quietly)
They usually have, Mrs. Grant.
The good ones.

37 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - STAIRWELL B - DAY
FRIDAY, AUGUST 19, 2005 - 9:44 AM

Raven sits on the stairs alone, the bicycle drawing on her knees. The door opens. Arianna. She stops when she sees Raven's face.

ARIANNA
(starting to back out)
I can go.

RAVEN
(wiping her eyes)
It's a stairwell, Cummings. It's not mine.

Arianna hesitates. Then sits two steps above her. The way Harmony sat for her yesterday.

ARIANNA
(looking at the drawing)
Is that you?

RAVEN
That's me. The bike's purple.

ARIANNA
(beat)
My mother forgot my birthday four years in a row. (beat) Fourteen to seventeen. I stopped reminding her.

Raven turns to look at her.

RAVEN
Mine pawned the TV on Christmas Eve. 1985. I was six. Grandma came and got me two weeks later. (beat) I told everybody at school we got a new one.

ARIANNA
(nodding)
Gary. Same story, different zip code.

RAVEN
Yamacraw Village. Savannah. Same story, different zip code.

They sit there. Two women who've spent their entire lives pretending to be fine.

ARIANNA
I passed Step Two. One eighty-nine.

RAVEN
(beat)
I know. Harmony told the whole house. (beat) Congratulations, Gary.

ARIANNA
(standing, brushing off her scrubs)
You're not going to tell anybody about this. You crying.

RAVEN
You're not going to tell anybody about your mom and the birthdays.

ARIANNA
(at the door)
Deal.

38 INT. THE HOUSE ON 49TH AVENUE - FRONT DOOR - DAY
FRIDAY, AUGUST 19, 2005 - 11:05 AM

The doorbell rings. Marc, showered now, in sweats, opens it. Elxa stands on the stoop in her residency scrubs, holding a sleeve of saltines and a box of Entenmann's.

ELXA
(holding up the saltines)
Russell says these are for you. (holding up the Entenmann's) These are for me. Don't touch them.

MARC
(beat)
Aren't you working?

ELXA
I'm on my break. I took a cab. (pushing past him) Kitchen. Now.

39 INT. THE HOUSE ON 49TH AVENUE - KITCHEN - DAY
FRIDAY, AUGUST 19, 2005 - 11:08 AM

Elxa sits at the island, already eating a crumb donut. Marc sits across from her with the saltines.

ELXA
So. Monty's.

MARC
(wincing)
Who told you?

ELXA
Monty told Gloria. Gloria told Deb. Deb told me in the elevator in front of two attendings and a candy striper. (beat) Five shots, Marc? You're six-foot-five and two hundred and twenty pounds. You should be able to handle five shots.

MARC
I hadn't eaten since Monday.

ELXA
(putting down the donut)
Yeah. That's what I'm here about.

She looks at him. The big sister look. The one she's been giving him since he was born.

ELXA
I saw it yesterday. From the nurses' station. I couldn't get to you.

MARC
(looking at the counter)
I'm sorry.

ELXA
Don't be sorry. Listen. (beat) Kingston wasn't yours to save. He was sick before you ever met him. Malachi was yours to save, and you saved him: you caught the burns, you made Celia call it in, you stood between that man and his sister. (beat) But you can't save everybody, Marc. Not by working a hundred hours. Not by sleeping at the hospital. Not by putting every bad man in Queens on the floor.

MARC
(quiet)
Watch me.

ELXA
(sharp)
That right there. That's the thing that's going to kill you. (beat) You think you're Superman. The Donohue heir, the Hopkins kid, the strongest man in every room. And maybe you are. But Superman doesn't skip lunch for ten days and then cry at a bar in Hunters Point.

Marc almost laughs.

MARC
Superman would never cry at Monty's. He'd go to a nicer bar.

ELXA
(beat, softening)
I'm going to have a baby in February. (beat) I need my baby to have an uncle. A whole one. Not a burnt-out one who's at the hospital every Christmas because he's afraid to stop moving.

Marc looks at her stomach. Just barely showing under her scrubs.

MARC
(quiet)
Okay.

ELXA
(standing, grabbing the Entenmann's)
Okay. (at the door) And Marc? Mama didn't suspend you because she's ashamed of you. She did it because she was scared. (beat) She called me at midnight. She never calls me at midnight.

She leaves. Marc sits alone with the saltines.

40 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - CHIEF'S OFFICE - DAY
FRIDAY, AUGUST 19, 2005 - 11:50 AM

Natasha at her desk, on the phone. Franklin Bassett (46), the hospital's general counsel, sits across from her with a legal pad.

NATASHA
(into the phone)
Yes, Dr. Wise. Monday at eight. (beat) No, I won't be there. I don't want to be anywhere near it. (beat) Thank you, Loretta. I mean it.

She hangs up. Bassett waits.

BASSETT
The Daily News is running the arrest tomorrow. Page twelve. "QUEENS DOC FLOORS ABUSE SUSPECT." No name for the doctor. Detective Vance made sure. (beat) The Post called too. I told them "no comment" in a tone that made them stop calling.

NATASHA
And the incident report?

BASSETT
Clean. The swing came first. Six witnesses. If Pryce's Legal Aid attorney tries a civil claim, I'll have it dismissed by Halloween. (beat) Tasha. Off the record. He did the right thing.

NATASHA
(beat)
He did the right thing the wrong way. In my hospital. (beat) And I have spent my entire career making sure nobody could ever say that the Chief's son got a different set of rules.

BASSETT
(gently)
He doesn't know that, you know. That that's why.

NATASHA
(looking out the window at the Citigroup tower)
He'll find out when he's a parent. That's when everybody finds out.

She picks up the phone again. Dials. This time she lets it ring.

41 INT. THE HOUSE ON 49TH AVENUE - LIVING ROOM - DAY
FRIDAY, AUGUST 19, 2005 - 11:52 AM

Marc on the fantastic couch, the throw blanket Esther used folded on the arm. His phone rings. He looks at the caller ID: "MAMA - OFFICE." He lets it ring twice. Then answers.

MARC
Dr. Bullock.

NATASHA (V.O.)
(beat)
Dr. Bullock. (beat) Your EAP appointment is confirmed for Monday, August 22nd, at eight o'clock in the morning. Dr. Loretta Wise. Her office is on the fourth floor of the Hunters Point building, Suite 410.

MARC
(formal)
Yes, ma'am.

NATASHA (V.O.)
You'll be cleared to return on Tuesday if she recommends it. (beat) That is the end of the Chief's business.

A long pause. Marc waits. He doesn't hang up.

NATASHA (V.O.)
(different voice, softer)
Marc-Anthony.

MARC
(closing his eyes)
Mama.

NATASHA (V.O.)
Did you eat?

MARC
(beat)
Saltines.

NATASHA (V.O.)
That's not food.

MARC
I know.

NATASHA (V.O.)
(beat)
I didn't do it because I'm ashamed of you.

MARC
(quiet)
I know that too. Elxa told me.

NATASHA (V.O.)
(a short, wet laugh)
Of course she did. (beat) Sunday dinner. Your father's making oxtails. You're coming. That's not the Chief talking either.

MARC
Yes, ma'am.

NATASHA (V.O.)
And Marc? (beat) The man who swung at you is in a cell at the 108th, and that little girl is at her great-grandmother's house tonight because of you. (beat) I'd suspend you again tomorrow. And I'd be proud of you again tomorrow. Both things. You hear me?

Marc can't speak. He nods, even though she can't see it.

MARC
(finally)
I hear you.

END OF ACT FIVE

TAG

42 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - RECOVERY ROOM - DAY
FRIDAY, AUGUST 19, 2005 - 1:30 PM

Romey Battle, intubated, groggy, coming out of anesthesia. Delores at his side, holding his hand. Amond stands at the foot of the bed with the chart.

DELORES
(to Amond)
Is it in? The new one?

AMOND
It's in, Mrs. Battle. The infection's out. He's going to be on antibiotics for six weeks, and then he goes straight to Phoenix House.

DELORES
(eyes wet)
Dr. Bullock told me you put it in. With your own hands.

AMOND
(beat)
Three stitches. Dr. Bullock did the rest.

Romey opens his eyes. Can't talk through the tube. He lifts one hand, slowly, and holds up seven fingers. Five on one hand, two on the other.

AMOND
(nodding)
Jerome Jr. I know. (beat)
Wednesdays, five o'clock. Don't make me wrong.

Romey closes his eyes. Delores keeps holding his hand.

43 INT. THE HOUSE ON 49TH AVENUE - LIVING ROOM - DAY
FRIDAY, AUGUST 19, 2005 - 2:14 PM

Afternoon light. Marc is asleep on the fantastic couch, really asleep for the first time in ten days, on his back, one arm over his eyes. The saltines are on the coffee table. The TV is muted on NY1.

The front door opens. Harmony, home early between shifts. She stops when she sees him.

She walks over quietly and looks down at him. He doesn't stir.

She takes the throw blanket off the arm of the couch, the one Esther used, and lays it over him. Tucks it at his shoulder.

Her hand goes to her pocket. The letter is there. She touches it through the fabric.

HARMONY
(barely a whisper)
Not today.

She sits down in the armchair across from him, takes out her Washington Manual and starts to read. Keeping watch.

Upstairs, in the hallway, the framed countdown and Crump's bow tie hang in the afternoon sun.

MARC (V.O.)
Every car comes with brakes.
Every body comes with a limit.

On NY1, silent, a chyron: "QUEENS: ABUSE SUSPECT ARRAIGNED, HELD ON $50,000 BAIL."

MARC (V.O.)
We spend our whole lives learning to ignore them. Interns are the best at it. We skip meals. We skip sleep. We skip the funerals and the phone calls and the part where you sit down and feel it.

44 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - ON-CALL ROOM 3 - DAY
FRIDAY, AUGUST 19, 2005 - 2:20 PM

Esther sits on a bunk on her break. She pulls the chain out from under her scrub top. The ring. She opens her RAZR: one missed call from a 617 number. Boston. She looks at it for a long moment. She doesn't call back. She tucks the ring back under her shirt.

MARC (V.O.)
And then one day the brakes go out, and you find out what you are at the bottom of the hill.

45 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - PEDIATRIC FLOOR - DAY
FRIDAY, AUGUST 19, 2005 - 2:25 PM

Nevaeh walks down the hall holding Odessa's hand, her backpack on, going home. She stops at the door of Room 4 and waves at Malachi through the glass. He waves back. Raven watches from the nurses' station, the bicycle drawing folded in her pocket.

MARC (V.O.)
The trick isn't never crashing.

Back at the house: Marc, asleep. Harmony, reading. The blanket rising and falling.

MARC (V.O.)
The trick is having somebody
who'll come find you when you do.

FADE OUT.

END OF EPISODE

Media Companion: Episode 1x07

Off-screen media around the episode, in chronological order. Not counted in page length (MA-009 §5).

ASSOCIATED PRESS: "BTK KILLER GETS 10 LIFE TERMS"

Thursday, August 18, 2005

"WICHITA, Kan. (AP) -- Dennis Rader, the church council president who terrorized Wichita for three decades as the self-named BTK strangler, was sentenced today to 10 consecutive life terms, one for each of the people he killed. He won't be eligible for parole for at least 175 years. Relatives of the victims confronted him in court before he spoke for about 20 minutes..."

SMS, Motorola RAZR (Arianna Cummings and Harmony Divine)

Thursday, August 18, 2005, 9:58 AM

Arianna: "dont tell anybody i cried"

Harmony: "u didnt cry. u 'had allergies' on a stairwell"

Arianna: "exactly"

Harmony: "189!!!!!!!!!"

Arianna: "stop"

Harmony: "ONE EIGHTY NINE"

Arianna: "...ok u can tell the house"

QueensGraceConfidential (Blogger)

Thursday, August 18, 2005, 6:12 PM

"BREAKING (by this blog's standards): an intern put a grown man on the ER floor this afternoon. Allegedly the man swung first, allegedly at a seven-year-old girl, allegedly the intern didn't throw a single punch. Big Ray pulled him off. Witnesses describe the intern's yelling as 'biblical.' The intern has been sent home. We're not printing the name, because the gossip in the cafeteria has three different names and we've been wrong before. Whoever you are, Dr. X: the nurses' station thinks you're a hero. Admin thinks you're paperwork. Both can be true." Comments (211).

AIM: away message, GaryGirl4Life (Arianna Cummings)

Thursday, August 18, 2005, 7:30 PM

"Officially a Doctor Who Passed Things. 189. Don't @ me. (Also: the good ones yell sometimes. Leave him alone.)"

BlackBerry email: Dr. Robert Bullock to Dr. Natasha Donohue

Thursday, August 18, 2005, 11:41 PM

Subject: (no subject)

"I'm sorry I left the room. I'm not sorry I said it. He's going to need both of us, and I don't know how to be the Chief and you don't know how to stop. I'll call him in the morning. You call him by noon. Oxtails Sunday. Love, R."

Sent from my BlackBerry Wireless Handheld

SMS, Motorola RAZR (Esther Smilley and Harmony Divine)

Thursday, August 18, 2005, 11:02 PM

Esther: "found him. monty's. hes home. hes ok"

Harmony: "thank you. thank u thank u"

Esther: "im staying on the couch. just to make sure"

Harmony: "ok"

(Harmony types "take care of him," deletes it, and types "good night" instead.)

Harmony: "good night"

SMS, Motorola RAZR (Elxa Bullock and Marc-Anthony Bullock)

Friday, August 19, 2005, 6:15 AM

Elxa: "i know about monty's"

Elxa: "i'm coming at 11 w crackers. be there or i call grandma josephine"

(No reply. Marc is asleep.)

Elxa: "i'm calling grandma josephine"

NEW YORK DAILY NEWS (page 12): "QUEENS DOC FLOORS ABUSE SUSPECT"

Saturday, August 20, 2005

"An Astoria man charged with torturing his girlfriend's 4-year-old son with lit cigarettes was wrestled to the floor by a doctor Thursday after he lunged at the boy's 7-year-old sister in a Queens hospital emergency room, police said. Dante Pryce, 24, was charged with assault, endangering the welfare of a child and attempted assault. He was arraigned yesterday in Queens Criminal Court and held on $50,000 bail. The boy, who suffered bleeding on the brain, is recovering at Queens Grace Hospital. Hospital officials declined to identify the doctor, a first-year resident who was not injured. 'That doctor didn't throw a punch,' said a witness who asked not to be named. 'He just would not let that man near that baby.'"

NY1: on-screen chyron

Friday, August 19, 2005, 2:14 PM

"QUEENS: ABUSE SUSPECT ARRAIGNED, HELD ON $50,000 BAIL"

Phoenix House intake confirmation (fax)

Friday, August 19, 2005, 4:30 PM

"RE: BATTLE, JEROME. A 28-day residential bed is reserved effective on discharge from Queens Grace Hospital (estimated September 30, 2005). Referring physician: R. Bullock, MD. Outpatient follow-up: A. Baker, MD (PGY-1), Wednesdays at 5:00 PM."

Continuity Sheet: Episode 1x07

New Canon Established

- **The first on-screen crash-out.** At 1:31 PM on Thursday, August 18, 2005, Dante Pryce lunged for Nevaeh Grant in the QGH ER. Marc blocked him and Dante swung first. Marc pinned him without throwing a punch, then kept roaring at him and didn't hear his name called four times. Big Ray pulled him off. Witnesses: Big Ray, Gloria, Natasha, Elxa, Det. Vance, Ms. Rawls. Earlier episodes are established in dialogue: Collegiate (age 15) and a Hopkins ER parking lot (Baltimore).
- **Discipline:** 48 hours of paid administrative leave plus an Employee Assistance Program evaluation with **Dr. Loretta Wise** (C-equiv. of Katharine Wyatt), Monday, August 22, 2005, 8:00 AM, Suite 410. This is Wise's first mention; her MA-005 recurring run (Seasons 5-6) is unchanged, and this is an off-screen, pre-run referral. Marc returns Tuesday, August 23, if cleared (resolved in 1x08).
- **Graves took Marc off a table** for a 2 mm tremor (fatigue). Marc had worked 98 logged hours in 10 days.
- **Marc drank 5 shots of Hennessy at Monty's;** Monty comped them. Esther found him ("Left on Jackson is Monty's"). On the stoop he started to tell her about Victor. Esther stopped him: **"Don't tell me drunk. Tell me sober."** On Friday she added: "Then later can still be later... Not because you're broken." She slept on the couch. **Nothing physical happened.**
- **Esther disclosed an uncle** who drank after Clarence's death and stayed with the family. She touched the ring on the chain, and got a missed call from a 617 (Boston) number she didn't return. That's Clayton thread, beat 6.
- **Arianna told Marc she knows** (Thursday, 3:15 PM, intern locker room). She promised to keep it. Marc now knows that she knows.
- **Arianna passed USMLE Step 2 CK with 189**, above the minimum passing score. She opened it with Harmony in Stairwell B. The program's August 31 condition is met.
- **Raven's backstory:** mother on crack, pawned the TV on Christmas Eve 1985, grandmother took her at 6 (Yamacraw Village, Savannah). Raven and Arianna made a stairwell pact.
- **Howard Divine's cough** is seeded (Thursday lunch). He promised an X-ray "after Labor Day." Harmony didn't push.
- **Romey Battle's contract** (non-binding) names "MY SON, JEROME JR. (7)." Redo tricuspid valve replacement on Friday, August 19 (Robert; Amond seated three sutures). Amond's Wednesday 5 PM follow-up is his first patient commitment.
- **Natasha and Robert's first on-screen marriage strain** ("Then I'll be his father. Somebody in this house should be."), reconciled by BlackBerry. Sunday oxtail dinner is set for August 21 (off-screen).
- **Harmony saw Esther on the couch** and moved the letter from her nightstand back into her pocket. In the Tag: "Not today." Raven has noticed.

- **Elxa:** "You can't save everybody." Natasha called her at midnight. Elxa is about 14.5 weeks pregnant.

Knowledge Tracker: Marc's True Identity (as of August 19, 2005)

Knows	Suspects / partial	Doesn't know
Family, Bernie, Graves, Gloria, Mrs. Truitt, Amond, Big Ray, Arianna (Marc now knows she knows)	Esther ("it involves a lot of money"; chose to wait), Crump	Raven, Harmony, Monty, Celia Montague, Det. Vance, the press; Julian Whitmore (C-073)

Patient Registry

Patient	DOB / age	Diagnosis	Procedure / surgeon	Outcome
Malachi Grant	1/3/2001 (4)	Acute subdural hematoma; older chronic subdural; fractures in different stages of healing; 3 cigarette burns on the arm (non-accidental trauma)	Craniotomy and evacuation (Graves; Marc removed)	Extubated 8/19, no deficits; kinship placement
Jerome 'Romey' Battle	6/1/1976 (29)	Third tricuspid endocarditis (IVDU) with annular abscess	Redo tricuspid valve replacement (Robert; Amond)	Stable; 6 weeks IV antibiotics, then Phoenix House
Dante Pryce	1981 (24)	Split lip (ER floor)	None	Arrested; $50,000 bail
Elxa Bullock	8/29/1977 (27)	Pregnancy, about 14.5 weeks	None	Well

New Characters (to add to MA-005 and MA-006)

- **Malachi Grant** (b. January 3, 2001); **Nevaeh Grant** (b. March 2, 1998); **Keyonna Grant** (b. 1984), their mother; **Odessa Grant** (b. 1937), great-grandmother, Jamaica, Queens, kinship foster parent.
- **Dante Pryce** (b. 1981), Keyonna's boyfriend.
- **Jerome 'Romey' Battle** (b. June 1, 1976); **Delores Battle** (b. 1947), retired MTA worker; Jerome Jr. (7, mentioned).
- **Ms. Thelma Rawls** (b. 1953), ACS caseworker. **Det. Andrea Vance** (b. 1967), Queens Child Abuse Squad. **Celia Montague**, QGH social worker (recurring).
- **Howard Divine** (b. August 30, 1950), Harmony's father and an MTA bus operator, appears on screen for the first time.

Real-World Accuracy Notes

- Dennis Rader (BTK) was sentenced on August 18, 2005, to 10 consecutive life terms in Wichita, Kansas. The 7 train runs elevated over Jackson Avenue and Queens Boulevard toward Queensboro Plaza. Citigroup Building (One Court Square) was the tallest building in

Queens in 2005. LIC is covered by the NYPD 108th Precinct (5-47 50th Avenue). Family Court for Queens sits in Jamaica.

- Child protection: physicians and hospital social workers are mandated reporters under New York Social Services Law §413, reporting to the Statewide Central Register (SCR). ACS investigates in NYC alongside NYPD Child Abuse Squads. Kinship foster placement with relatives and orders of protection are standard.
- Medicine: patterned circular burns about 8-10 mm wide are classic for cigarettes; healing fractures of different ages are a red flag. Recurrent tricuspid endocarditis in injection drug users, and the ethics of re-operation, were a live debate in 2005. Methadone maintenance and Phoenix House (NYC, founded 1967) are period-accurate. USMLE Step 2 CK reported a three-digit score in 2005.
- Tech: Motorola RAZR V3, BlackBerry 7290, AIM away messages and Blogger are period-accurate. Hennessy and Entenmann's are correct New York texture.